Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**ECONOMICS**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	To what extent has the minimum price per unit in Scotland been effective in reducing consumption and demand for alcohol since 2018?		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	The research question (RQ) is relevant to the topic of the investigation (the impact of the minimum price of alcohol) and clear but only partially focused in relation to the scope of the question. The RQ is not clearly stated within the essay, but it is included on the cover sheet and is implicit in the early part of the essay. Nevertheless, it remains quite broad. Research methods that are mostly suitable are explained and applied with partial effectiveness. Appropriate and relevant secondary research is used to address aspects of the RQ. Structural conventions used in the essay support some aspects of the communication of the research. • Data is well-presented, with titles and figure numbers, and actual values on a diagram. • The bibliography is presented accurately in alphabetical order, making it easy to crosscheck the references. • Footnotes are presented accurately, but do not consistently match the way they are presented in the bibliography. There seem to be several items in the bibliography that are not cited within the essay. • There is a tendency to present some important information in lists.	
B: Knowledge and understanding	**4**	Relevant research materials are used to establish some knowledge of the subject matter.	

[Maximum possible mark: 6]		Some relevant terminology is used accurately. Some relevant concepts are explained and used with partial effectiveness. Relevant concepts/theories include: • Minimum price theory • Price elasticity of demand • Impact of inflation in eroding the effectiveness of the minimum prices • Some reference to bounded self-interest and rational decision making
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	The essay includes analysis that is partially effective and produces some relevant findings. A partially consistent argument links the research question, research findings and conclusions. The order of the discussions points is somewhat of a limitation; the theory of minimum price would have been more effective at the outset, with the elasticity analysis being used to evaluate the effectiveness of the policy. The theory associated with price elasticity of demand in Section 1 is analysed more effectively than the others, as there is more support from the research. Some areas of the argument remained rather descriptive/theoretical, rather than analytical and based on research findings.
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**6**	A balanced discussion of the significance of the findings is often supported by appropriate evidence. An evaluation of the effectiveness of the essay is present, with relevant strengths and limitations described. There is some evidence of evaluation throughout the essay: • a clearly explained rationale is given for the choice of topic and selection of sources • page 9 – evaluation of price and sales values • page 10 – evaluation of data • page 12 – evaluation of own findings • page 14 – evaluation of minimum price as a tool for correcting marking failure (although this is not very well supported by the research)
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**2**	Reflection on the extended essay is descriptive and includes some specific examples. Reflection sometimes shows evidence of the student's growth and transfer of learning.
Total marks awarded	20/30	
Holistic comment on the essay:	Overall, this is a satisfactory piece academic writing. The student shows some knowledge and understanding of the topic in the wider context of	

	the discipline. There is attempted application of source material and appropriate terminology and concepts. At times, the arguments are descriptive, rather than analytical, with not all assertions backed by research. There is partially successful evaluation of the research.